

Cooperative education is the cornerstone of Northeastern University's experiential learning approach, in which on-campus study is enhanced by real-world experience through full-time opportunities at locations worldwide. Through co-op, students alternate periods of academic courses with periods of work in positions related to their academic or career interests. This combination provides an integrated learning experience that enhances both in-class studies and career development.

Undergraduate students can complete up to two co-ops in four years. Most graduate students complete one co-op experience.

Most co-ops are 6 month work experiences aligned with academic terms (Spring/Summer I, Summer II/Fall), but can vary between 4-8 months. A sample undergraduate schedule is available in the quick links section under "Typical Co-op Cycles". For detailed information on the co-op process, policies, and additional student information, please refer to the Co-op FAQ belo

How does the co-op process work?

Students begin the co-op process by registering for the mandatory co-op preparatory course or equivalent, where they are assigned a co-op coordinator/advisor*. The co-op prep course is a class taught by co-op coordinators/advisors that provides students with the tools, skills and values necessary to obtain and excel in a co-op position and in their future job searches and employment. More information about a co-op coordinator/advisor can be found below.

After successfully completing the co-op preparatory course, students will be able to begin to apply for co-op positions, as long as all eligibility requirements (listed below) have been met, and their resume has been approved by their advisor/coordinator. Once approved, students can search within Northeastern's job platform Nuworks or find co-op positions using other resources. Read on to learn more about NUworks.

Students searching for their first co-op typically can begin applying for jobs at the beginning of their search cycle semester. The co-op search process mimics a typical job search; students will review and apply for jobs with their resume, complete applications, interview, and accept offers. A student's co-op coordinator/advisor will be able to provide guidance throughout the application and interview process.

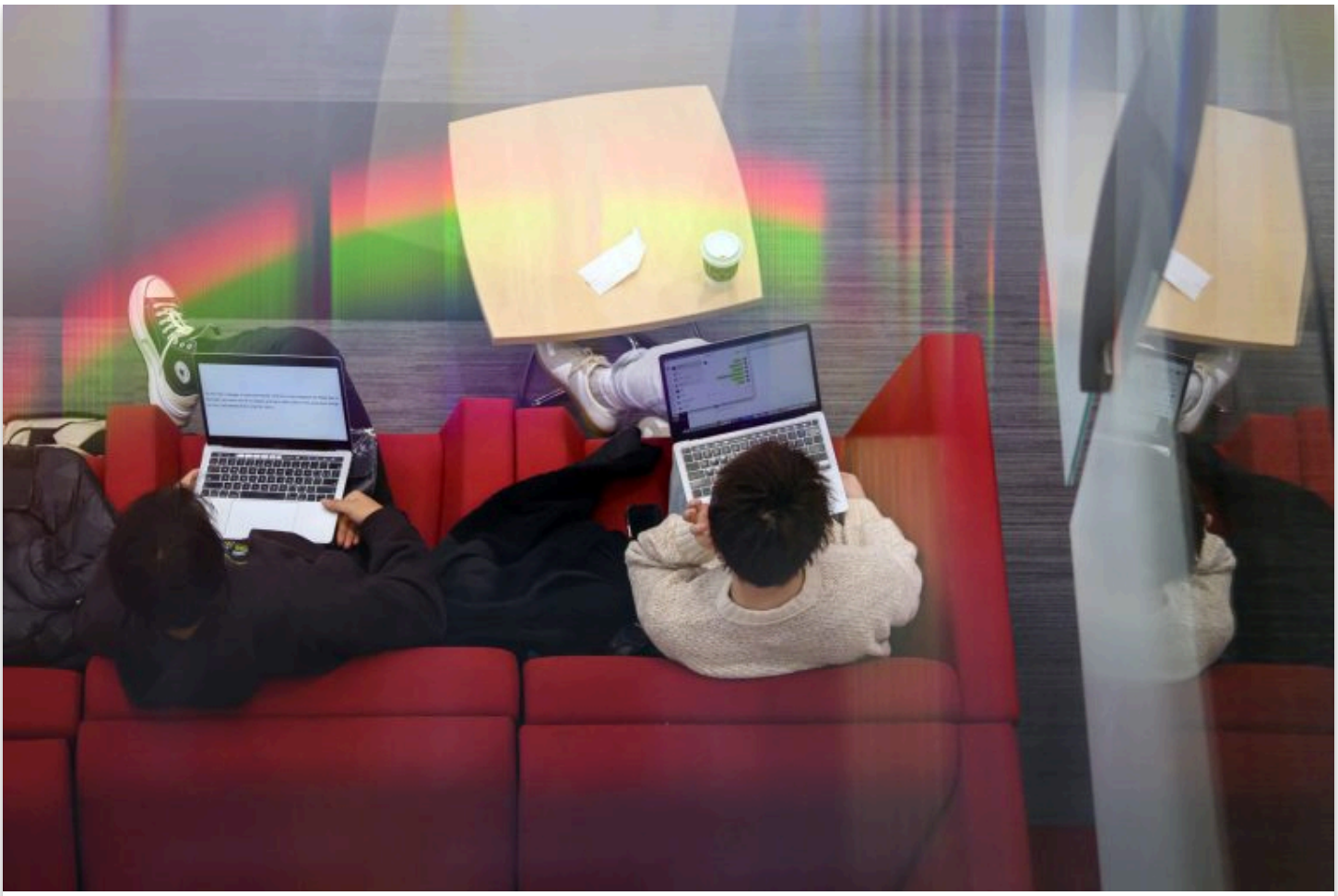
Once students have received a job offer, they should let their co-op coordinator/advisor know. All co-op jobs must be approved by a student's co-op coordinator/advisor. Note that reneging on an accepted job offer is not permitted and may result in consequences that affect co-op eligibility and participation.

*__Note:__ Coordinator/advisor assignment timing may vary depending on their status as a graduate or undergraduate student, and their degree program.

What is a Co-op Coordinator/Advisor?

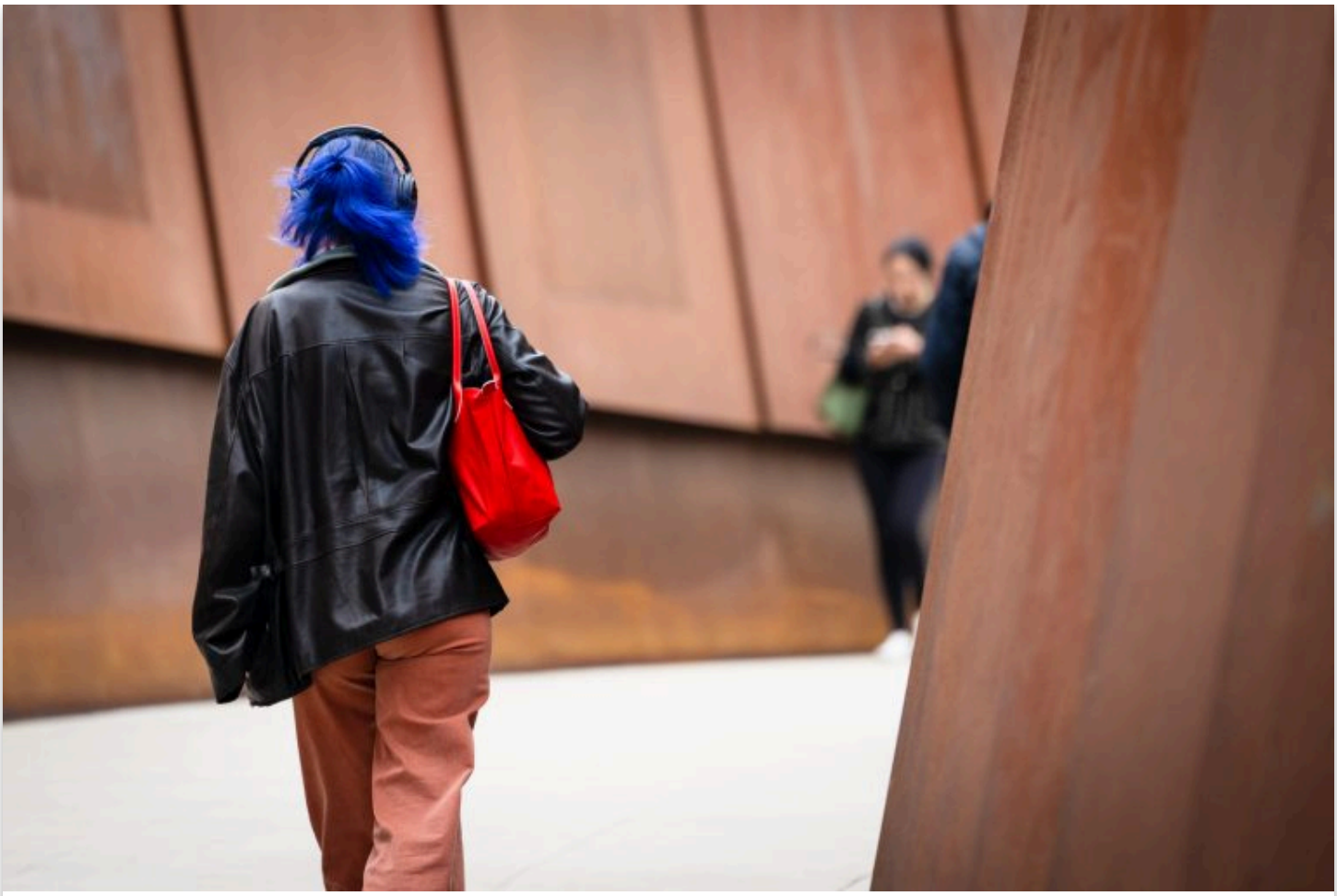
Each student is assigned a co-op coordinator/advisor based on their chosen major and home college. Co-op coordinators/advisors provide 1:1 support for students throughout their co-op journey at Northeastern, and develop relevant co-op opportunities with employer partners

In addition to teaching the co-op class that covers job searching skills like writing resumes/cover letters and preparing to interview, co-op coordinator/advisors work with students to: (1) identify career interests and long term goals; (2) apply for appropriate co-op positions; (3) develop individualized strategies for their co-op search; (4) assist students if any questions or concerns arise while they are on co-op; and (5) facilitate learning and reflection upon completion of a co-op.



NUWorks Access

NUWorks is the platform that connects Northeastern Students with co-op opportunities.



Co-op Policies

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International Student Resources

International students are eligible to participate in co-op, though must follow certain requirements and processes to be approved.



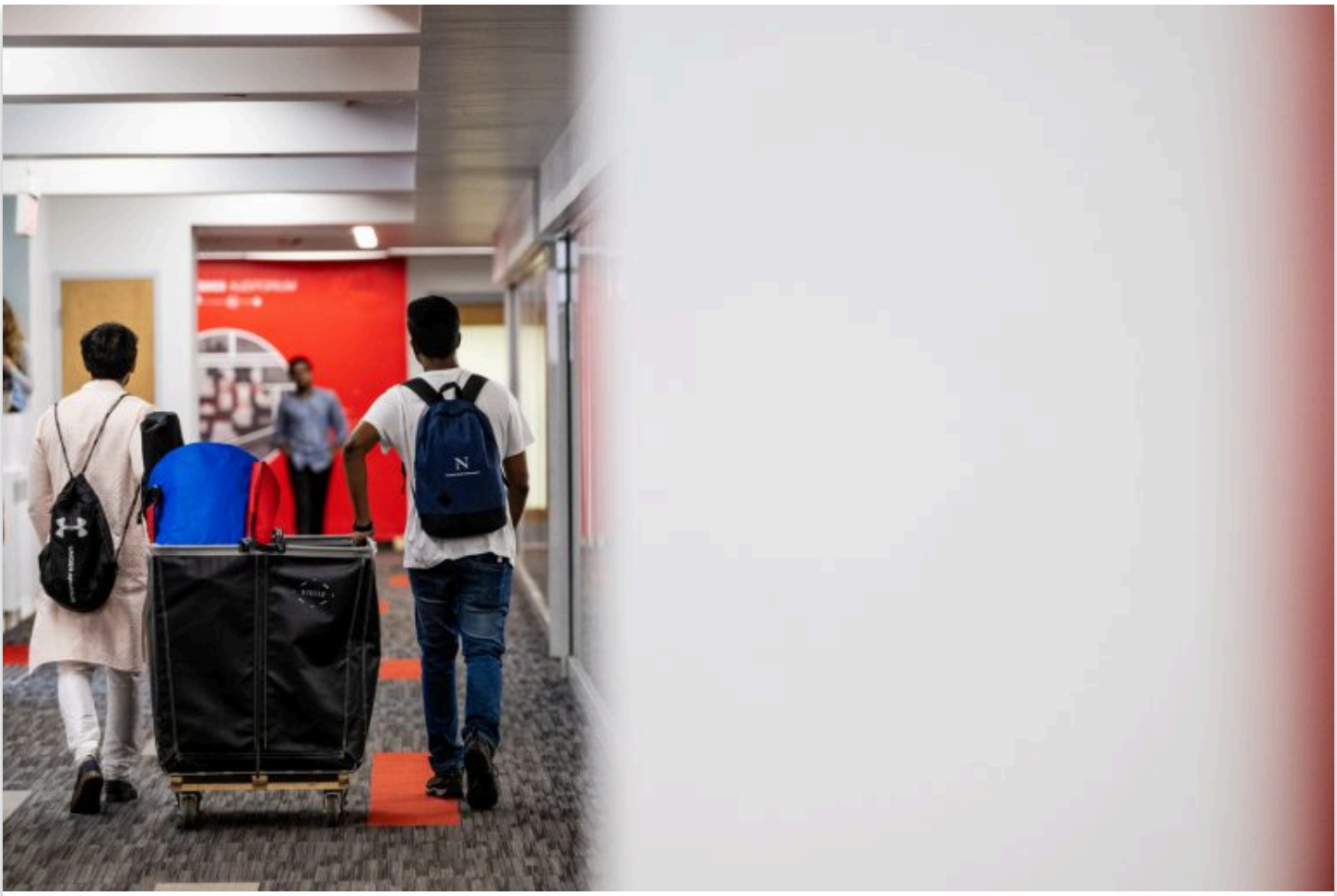
Transportation Resources

Navigating Boston and your co-op journey can be made seamless with the variety of transportation options available to Northeastern students.



Wellness Resources

Northeastern offers a variety of wellness support for all students throughout the co-op journey.



Global Co-op & Relocation Resources

Completing a co-op outside of Boston, but staying in the United States? Northeastern offers a variety of relocation support for students completing a co-op experience in another part of the country.

Co-op FAQ

- Is co-op required? ›
- Are students guaranteed a co-op? ›
- Can international students participate in co-op? ›
- Where can students do co-op? ›

- Are all co-ops paid?
- Are all co-ops full-time?
- What are the eligibility requirements for co-op participation?
- How do students search for co-op positions?
- Can students find their own co-op outside of NUworks?
- How do students handle job offers?
- Do students pay tuition when on co-op?
- Can students take classes while on co-op?
- Can students graduate on co-op?
- What happens if students don’t get a co-op during their search?
- Do students get a grade for co-op?